Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

Metropolitan Planning Commission Meeting - November 5th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qgoAaY6bTmE
Publication Date	2026-11-05T23:40:55Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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REPORT OUTLINE & STRUCTURE

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(None recorded in the transcript.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called to order the November 2026 Delaware Muny Metropolitan Plan Commission meeting at 00:03:13.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Members Present:** Tom Borchers, Steven Brand, Nate Carroll, Jerry Dishman, Teresa Hensley, Richard Ivy, Owen Lache, Jesse Landis, Adam Leach, Ricky Cyp, and Chris Smith. (Note: Emily Cring was noted as an advisory member attending later or reviewing remotely).
  - **Members Absent:** None explicitly recorded (all voting members present at roll call).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Unnamed Chair / President conducting the meeting.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led at 00:03:28.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Motion made and seconded to approve the October 2026 minutes as submitted. Roll call vote recorded: Brand (Yes), Carol (Yes), Dishman (Yes), Hensley (Yes), Ivy (Yes), Lache (Yes), Landis (Abstain), Cyp (Yes), Smith (Yes). Disposition: **Approved**.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:06:33 **Ordinance MPC06-26A: McKinley Neighborhood Overlay District**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Joe Robertson (representing the volunteer drafting committee) and Rachel Robertson (Vice President of the McKinley Live and Learn Neighborhood Association).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Joe Robertson presented a continuation of the public hearing for the comprehensive zoning ordinance text amendment regarding a proposed overlay district in the McKinley neighborhood. Background details noted that the overlay previously passed 8-0 locally but was vetoed by the acting mayor due to a state law change taking effect July 1st. The revised draft removes affected language, adds a grandfather clause exempting current owner-occupied existing residents, revises setbacks and lot coverage, adds Accessory Dwelling Unit (ADU) standards, and aligns with the mayor's master plan and design guidelines. Staff member Kylen noted the ongoing Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) rewrite is reviewing the document concurrently.
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Rachel Robertson spoke in support on behalf of the McKinley neighborhood board of directors, highlighting door-to-door engagement, support from community organizations (YMCA, Muny Community Schools), and zero remaining concerns from residents. No members of the public spoke in opposition.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to grant a favorable recommendation. Roll call vote: Brand (Yes), Carol (Yes), Dishman (Yes), Hensley (Yes), Ivy (Yes), Lache (Yes), Landis (Yes), Cyp (Yes), Smith (Yes). Disposition: **Passed 9-0 (Favorable Recommendation forwarded to City Council for a December 7th hearing)**.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No dedicated general public comment forum occurred; public input was restricted to the specific agenda hearing item above. Board members engaged in general administrative and policy discussions detailed below.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

    - **Director's Report (00:14:38):** Kylen reported active numbers through October (767 permits issued, 1,444 inspections, 107 site/sign plans reviewed, and 113 total committee cases). Noted staff transitions (Liz Wilcox moved to County HR, Desiree moved to Planning Tech, Billy Kester hired as secretary, and Kayla Ferguson left for Indianapolis, leaving one staff opening). Reported on attendance at the Neighborhood Leadership Council (NLC) meeting and co-hosting the successful "Creating Livable Communities" NPO conference in Kokomo with Governor Mike Braun and regional mayors in attendance.
    - **2027 Calendar (00:21:35):** Presented the 2027 meeting schedule (first Thursday of every month at 6:00 PM, with the July meeting adjusted to the second Thursday, July 8th, due to the holiday). Approved by Voice Vote.
    - **Board Terms Expiring at Year-End (00:41:57):** Kylen reminded members whose terms expire at the end of the year (Chris Smith, Nate Carroll, Teresa Hensley, and annual appointments for Brand and Dishman) to contact their appointing bodies regarding reappointment. Commissioner Brand noted county commissioners will wait until January to make appointments due to an incoming commissioner.
    - **Board Discussions (00:22:50 & 00:30:13):** Extended board discussion regarding permit fee distribution (allocating 90% to county general and 10% to unsafe housing/blight remediation) and future regulatory planning for data centers under the upcoming UDO update.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following final board remarks without a formal spoken adjournment timestamp.

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